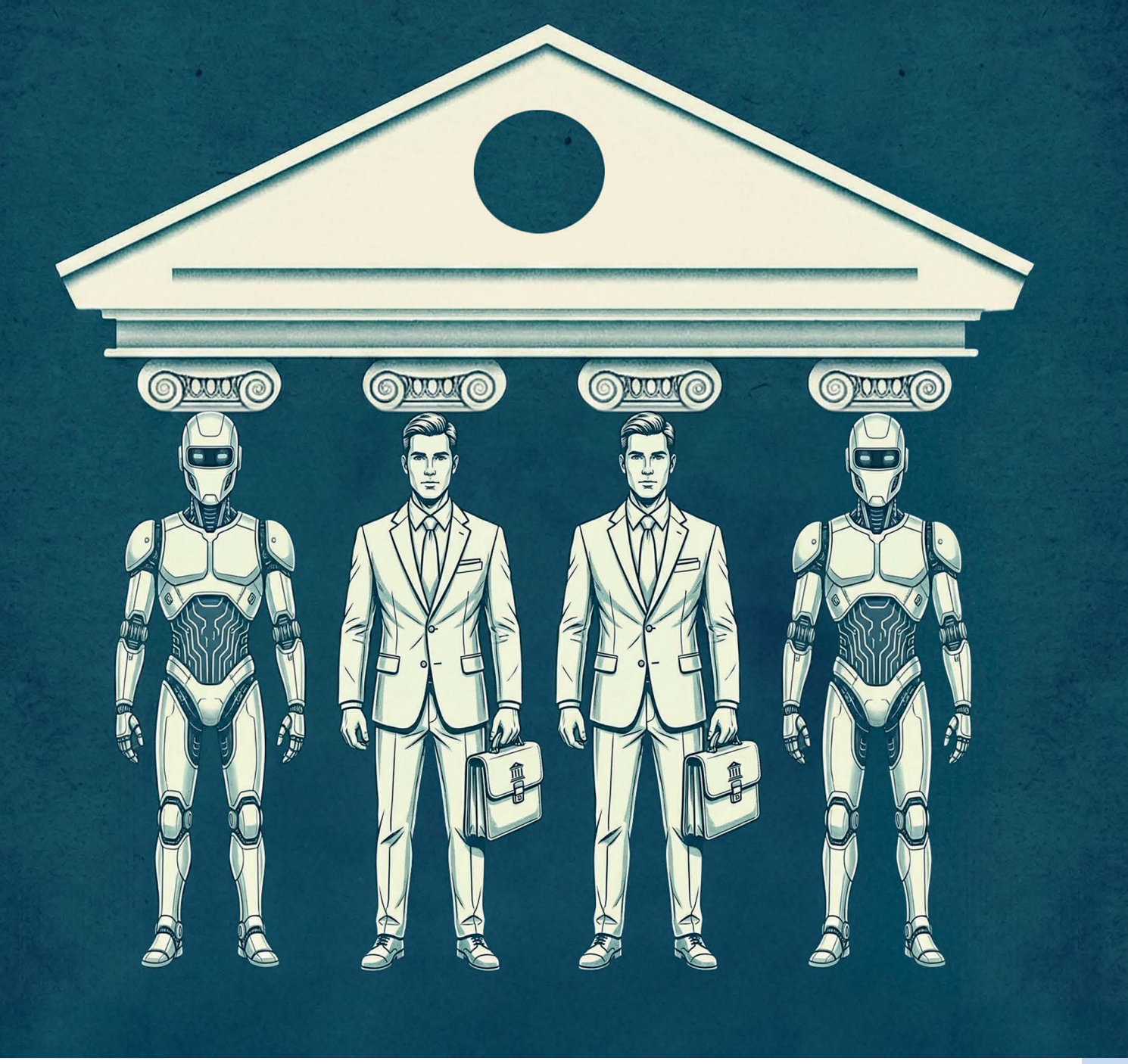


possibility. It is emerging in front of us as algorithms influence the flow of credit, the movement of markets and the detection of fraud. The question now is not whether AI will transform finance, but how thoughtfully this transformation will be guided. If implemented responsibly, AI can expand inclusion, strengthen institutions and improve the overall stability of financial systems. If left without guardrails, the same tools can create opaque risks and widen existing inequalities.

THE WAY INDIAN BANKS **BALANCE INNOVATION WITH EXPLAINABILITY AND REGULATORY OVERSIGHT** MAY WELL BECOME A GLOBAL REFERENCE POINT FOR RESPONSIBLE AI IN FINANCE

The year ahead offers an opportunity to shape a more resilient and equitable financial landscape. The challenge is to ensure that innovation and governance grow at the same pace. Finance has always depended on foresight. Today, that foresight must extend to the algorithms that silently shape the choices, risks and opportunities of the automated economy. ■

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Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**